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You *Can* Kick the Work Habit

So maybe you're starting to believe you might be able to live on \$40,000 a year. During college and the first years on the job you lived on a fraction of that. Remember those times? Gas cost 25 cents a gallon and gas station attendants spoke English. Spiro Agnew pleaded *nolo contendere* with honor. Detroit pushed big cars.

In many ways your life was better back then. Sure, it was great to make a few bucks. A few bucks helped a lot in the first few years of marriage and family life. But somewhere along the way things got distorted. The concept of family faded away. Economic security, once based on savings and parental support, changed when the Treasury started cranking the presses into overdrive, and advertising persuaded baby boomers to squeeze out every last dollar for image-based purchases. Social values shifted when 20-year-olds who protested against Vietnam, racism, and poverty grew up and dropped out into the world of vacation condos, status cars, and exclusive golf clubs.

Deep down you know you can live without the new BMW, the beach house, and \$35 hamburgers; without Valiums, two divorces and their \$90,000 lawyer's fees, and feeling slightly self-conscious in a not-yet-upscaled Burger King.